What I still need from Heritage Bites

Heritage Bites website · outstanding items after the 27 October 2026 answers, updated 28 October 2026 with the notification sign-off

Your answers are in and the site has been updated to match them. The full response — what changed, why, and how production card payments work — is in [`regomoditswe-answers-2026-10.md`](regomoditswe-answers-2026-10.md). This page is only the short list of what is still open.

From you (content)

1. **Photos for Tlhakwana and Smiley.** Both plates currently show a "photo coming soon" panel. Please send one photo each, in the same tray-and-plate style as the others. Do not send a photo of a different dish to fill the gap.
2. **Drinks, if you sell them online.** Names and prices. They are not on the site at the moment because no drinks were signed off.
3. **Add-ons, if they exist.** For example an extra starch or an extra side, with the price. The old R18–R65 add-ons were invented, so they were removed rather than guessed.
4. **The exact collection point** at Standard Bank, Rosebank and Sandton. Until then the site says the point is confirmed by WhatsApp.
5. **Uber Eats / Mr D store links**, if you use those platforms. Direct "share store" URLs only — the buttons stay disabled until then.
6. **Confirm the contact-form inbox.** Your Formspree endpoint is wired in; please confirm it delivers to `heritagebitesfood@gmail.com` and who is responsible for replying.

From the account owner (secrets — never send them to me)

1. **Gmail App Password** for `heritagebitesfood@gmail.com`, entered directly in the host's secret settings as `HB_SMTP_PASS`. This is what makes order emails start sending.
2. **Yoco live keys** (`sk_live_…` and `pk_live_…`), entered directly in the host's secret settings. This is what turns the test card form into real card payments.
3. **Hosting decision.** Tell me the host/account (for example Afrihost Cloud/VPS) once it is chosen. I need Node.js 20+, HTTPS and a persistent data folder; there is no database to buy at this stage.

To prove the notifications actually arrive (not just "configured")

The code is finished and tested, but a notification is only real when a person sees it. Four links in the chain need you, because they live on your accounts, your phone and your domain — I have no way to test them from here.

1. **A place for the site to run, with HTTPS.** This is the first blocker and most things wait on it. The GitHub Pages link is a static preview: it can show the menu, but it cannot take an order, send email or wake a phone. Anything with Node.js 20+, HTTPS and a persistent folder works — Render, Railway and Fly all have free tiers, and Afrihost Cloud/VPS is fine too. Tell me which one you want and I will prepare the exact settings for it.

1. **The email password.** For `heritagebitesfood@gmail.com`: turn on 2-step verification, create an **App Password**, and paste the 16 characters into the host's secret settings as `HB_SMTP_PASS`. Not in this chat, not in an email, not in a document — straight into the host. Also tell me: **who watches that inbox during the Thursday/Friday window**, and whether a second person needs the kitchen alert too (it currently goes to one address).

1. **Push keys, created on the host.** Run `npm run push:keys` there once and put the two values in as `HB_VAPID_PUBLIC_KEY` and `HB_VAPID_PRIVATE_KEY`. Then choose a long password for `HB_OWNER_PUSH_KEY` — that is what stops a stranger enrolling their own phone. I need to be told they are set, never what they are.

1. **Your phones.** Which phone(s) should buzz, and who holds them. For each: open `/alerts` on the site, paste the owner key, tap allow. On **iPhone** this only works on iOS 16.4 or newer, in Safari, and only **after** Share → **Add to Home Screen** — without that step Safari will never deliver a push, and it gives no error to say so. Android and desktop work directly.

Then I will place a real R100 test order and you confirm three things with your own eyes:

- the **kitchen ticket** email is in the inbox;
- the **alert pops up on the phone** with the site closed;
- the **customer receipt** arrives at a second address you control (use your own Gmail as the customer — do not use a real customer's address for a test).

Two decisions while you are there:

1. **Where customer receipts are sent from.** Simplest: the same Gmail account, free, no setup — but mail sent from `gmail.com` whose links point at `heritagebites.co.za` looks like spoofing, so some receipts will land in spam. Better: Brevo's free plan (300 emails a day, no card) with `heritagebites.co.za` verified, which needs someone with access to the domain's DNS to add SPF and DKIM records once. Tell me who controls that DNS.

1. **What should trigger an alert.** Today it is one alert per order, at the moment it is placed. Nobody is told when an order is accepted, ready, or cancelled — there is no staff screen to change a status, so there is nothing to notify about yet. If you want "your food is ready" messages, that is a small feature to commission, not a setting to switch on.

What I have already proven without you: orders queue when email is missing and do not block checkout, retries back off and give up after five attempts, broken push keys are reported loudly instead of pretending to work, and the health check exits with an error when any channel is broken. What it cannot prove is delivery — only your inbox and your phone can.

What I will do once those are in place

- Load the two photos and publish them.
- Add drinks and any confirmed add-ons to the menu with their prices.
- Switch order emails and live card payments on, and run a real R100 test order plus a refund.
- Enrol your phone for order alerts, place a live test order, and confirm with you that the email, the push and the customer receipt all arrived.
- Publish the exact collection point.
- Enable the delivery-partner buttons when real store links exist.